

that children are influenced far too much by advertising, and if we can't eliminate it altogether, we should at least attempt to link premiums and promotions to good healthy food.

That is what Disney and Nickelodeon promised to do in 2006 in a move to tie their characters to lower-calorie foods. Disney included milk and fruit in the meals served at their theme parks, while Nickelodeon added popular character graphics on packages of fruit in 2007. Some high-ranking Disney officials also suggested that part of their company's decision not to renew the McDonald's exclusive movie tie-in contract was to put some distance between their company and the increasing obesity epidemic. This, despite the fact that McDonald's had already offered healthier choices of milk and apples to their children's menu and Disney continued to serve hamburgers and fries at their theme park. Fear of fat didn't stop DreamWorks Animation from signing a deal with McDonald's that year with promotions that tied in to the release of *Shrek 3*, but then what can we expect from a fat green ogre?

Premiums remain a popular form of promotion geared toward children, but more and more companies are shifting gears and business practices tying those promotions to healthier foods. In the fall of 2006, ten large food and beverage companies, including Kellogg's, vowed to strengthen their self-regulatory guidelines when marketing to children under the age of twelve. At least 50 percent of their ads would promote healthy food choices.

But what about the premiums and refunds geared to adults—the hundreds of new offers we used to see listed in our refund magazines every month? Now dubbed “rebates,” they are fewer and farther between. For those of us